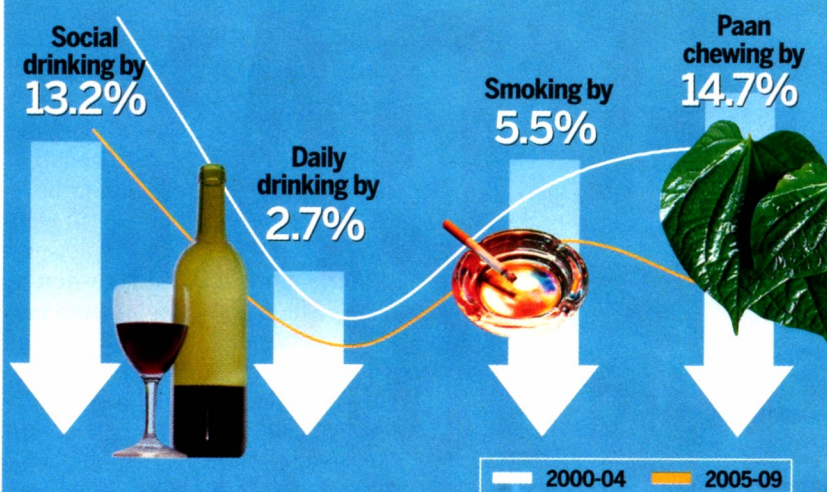




ADDICTION DROP

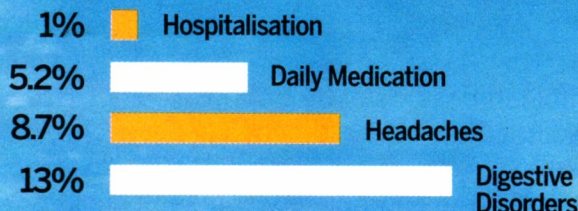
Significant fall in unhealthy habits



51% are reported to have high cholesterol levels, compared to 65% five years back

DAILY SICKNESS

There has been a dip in chronic ailments



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Earn more, want more and spend more" is slowly becoming the mantra of the Indian middle class. But are we really aware of the virus that is slowly and surreptitiously chewing up our emotional wellbeing? Nuclear family setups mean higher expectations from each other. Parents need to work toward a healthy balance between work, home and self-care. Also employers need to understand that driving their employees like machines is not going to be effective. Some top companies are taking care of employee wellbeing through stress management workshops, flexible times, yoga and meditation.

56%

was the average age for onset of lifestyle diseases in 2002; came down to 48 years in 2006

50%

of the world's cardiac patients slated to be from India by 2010

blood pressure, joint problems to headaches—all seem to be on a downward spiral.

While right-minded citizens seem to be dieting with dedication, and talking fanatically about healthy living, numbers need to make sense beyond personal metrics into larger trends and population studies. Taken together, the survey in hand provides a fairly clean bill of health to urban India.

—with inputs from Aditi Seshadri, Sholli Sarkar Seth, Sharmi Ghosh Dastidar